vomiting and passing roundworms and their eggs in the stool.

8.6.7 Laboratory Diagnosis

Specimen collected: Stool, sputum and blood.

Detection of parasite

Adult worm: It can be detected in stool or sputum of patient by naked eye. Pancreatic or biliary worms can be detected by ultra-sound and endoscope.

Larvae: Larvae can be detected in sputum and often in gastric washings. Chest X – ray may show pulmonary infiltrates.

Eggs: Detection is through demonstration of eggs in feces. Detection of both fertilized and unfertilized eggs are made after staining. Eggs may be demonstrative in the bile obtained by duodenal aspirates.

Blood Examination

Complete blood count may show eosinophilia in early stage of infection.

Serological tests

Ascaris antibody can be detected by IHA, IFA and ELISA

8.6.8 Treatment

Commonly used drugs are Albendazole and Mebendazole.

8.6.9 Prevention and Control

a. Proper health education should be given for improved sanitation and personal hygiene.



The National Deworming Day (Febuary 10th) is an initiative of India to make every child in the country worm free. This is one of the largest public health programs reaching large number of children during a short period.

More than 836 million children are at risk of parasitic worm infections worldwide. According to World Health Organization 241 million children between the ages of 1 and 14years are at risk of parasitic intestinal worms in India, also known as Soil-Transmitted Helminths (STH).

b. Avoid eating of uncooked green vegetable, food preparation and fruits that may contain faecal eggs.

c. Treating infected persons especially children. Deworming of school children have been found effective in control of ascariasis.

Summary

Medical Parasitology deals with the study of parasites infecting humans. The diseases caused by them and the clinical manifestations produced in infected humans. It is also concerned with various methods of their diagnosis, treatment and their prevention and control. There are different types of parasites and hosts. Parasites lives on its host for its nourishment and survival. The relationship between host and the parasite can be symbiotic,

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